

STATEMENT • PANEL • STRUCTURE

split-panel

Featured left panel + supporting right zone — one prominent claim beside the points that substantiate it.

The featured panel makes the claim; this side supports it.

A dark left panel carries the headline, and the bright right column holds up to three supporting items.

Two zones, one argument

The split is hierarchy, not decoration — the panel claims, the column proves.

Three items is the comfort zone

A short title and one supporting line each, like this.

Prose stays on a budget

Sixteen words per item keeps the column scannable.

SPLIT-PANEL METRIC

16wpi

Words per item — the budget this layout holds its supporting column to.

The panel flips light

metric flips the panel light behind one hero number.

The number claims

Keep support brief — two items beside a figure.



*pullquote gives half the
slide to one voice, and the
other half to what it means.*

split-panel pullquote · the layout, quoted

pullquote · split-panel pullquote – Half the slide to one quotation.

The quote claims

Display italic on the dark panel; keep it under twenty-five words.

The column interprets

Two items that say why the words matter, not who said them again.

02

steps

The left panel anchors a phase; the column numbers its moves.

1

Watermark the phase

The inline-code number becomes the panel's backdrop.

2

Number the column

An ordered list reads as sequence — three steps fit.

3

Keep steps parallel

Verb-first titles, one supporting line each.



Watermark

The heading's first letter becomes the panel

The accent panel decorates

A large letterform behind the heading — presence without a photo.

The h3 subtitles

One line naming what the slide surveys.

The column carries the content

Same three-item budget as the default split.

Execute with accuracy.

How is this done?

You recall syntax, patterns, and standards
— the path is known, and the job is to

follow it without error. — Scenario signal + two paired proof cards, filling the column top to bottom. Narrows the claim panel to 31% and steps the claim heading to the h2 tier — the evidence side carries three stacked regions where the base carries one list.

YOU KNOW YOU'RE HERE WHEN

You ship on an existing API and rework is rare.

FOLLOWS EXAMPLES WELL

Compiles, runs, and tests locally with confidence.

WORKS FROM BRIEF TICKETS

Consistent quality without hand-holding.

Build what didn't exist before.

What should exist?

You synthesize new frameworks, platforms and operating models — what you produce becomes the standard.

capstone · split-panel capstone — Composes with as plain top-rule pillars — the sequence's climactic, most-earned entry.

THE SIGNAL

Teams across the enterprise adopt your framework as their foundation.

REFERENCE ARCHITECTURE

The implementation exists and is validated.

ORGANIZATION-WIDE ADOPTION

Measurable outcomes follow.

proof: the signal reads as a quoted card, the two proof points read

Reading order still works

The eye crosses support first, then lands on the panel's claim.

Use it sparingly

One mirror per section keeps the flip meaningful.

SPLIT-PANEL MIRROR

mirror puts the
featured panel
on the right.

Same anatomy, flipped — for when the deck's rhythm wants the claim to land late.

The payload bullet becomes a code on the panel.

A bare URL auto-resolves; the caption
line labels the scan.

qr · split-panel qr – Payload bullet becomes a code.



Scan for this layout's docs

STAGE 1 OF 8

Discover the real problem.

cat-1 • split-panel cat-1 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #1 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Talk to the people living with it

Five conversations beat one survey.

Write down what surprised you

The surprise is usually the actual problem.

Define what "done" means.

cat-2 · split-panel cat-2 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #2 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

One sentence, not a document

If it needs a meeting to explain, it isn't defined yet.

Name what's explicitly out of scope

The edges matter more than the center.

STAGE 3 OF 8

Design the smallest real version.

cat-3 • split-panel cat-3 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #3 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Cut until it's uncomfortable

Comfortable scope is usually still too big.

Sketch before you spec

A rough picture surfaces disagreement a document hides.

Build the thing you designed.

cat-4 • split-panel cat-4 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #4 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Ship the ugly path first

It finds the real risk; the happy path is easy.

Keep a running list of shortcuts taken

Nothing is forgotten faster than a deliberate shortcut.

Validate with the people it's for.

cat-5 • split-panel cat-5 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #5 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Watch, don't narrate

What they do matters more than what they say they'd do.

One real user beats five imagined ones

A single honest session outweighs a week of speculation.

STAGE 6 OF 8

Launch to a small, real audience.

Small enough to fix fast

A limited launch turns mistakes into hours, not weeks.

Tell people it's early

Set the expectation and the feedback gets more honest.

STAGE 7 OF 8

Scale what actually worked.

cat-7 • split-panel cat-7 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #7 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Scale the mechanism, not the guess

Confirm why it worked before you multiply it.

Expect the edges to break first

Scale finds every assumption that only held at small size.

STAGE 8 OF 8

Sustain it without you in the loop.

cat-8 • split-panel cat-8 – Override: pins this slide to the theme's categorical slot #8 – the claim panel's fill, and under `proof` the checkpoint labels' ink. Normally unnecessary – `proof` slides are tinted automatically by deck order.

Write down what only you know

If it lives in your head, it isn't sustained yet.

Hand off the decision, not just the task

Ownership transfers when someone else can say no.

Five full items is this column's ceiling.

The framing paragraph can run two lines when every item below uses its whole budget, but nothing here may run longer.

First item at full width

Sixteen words of support is the budget, and this line is written to land exactly on it, deliberately.

Second item, same weight

Parallel structure keeps a maxed column readable; vary the openings and the scan collapses.

Third item holds the middle

Every row carries a short bold title and one line of support, never two, at this count.

Fourth item keeps the rhythm

The column is tight here; a longer opening on any row starts to crowd the one beneath.

Fifth item closes the set

A sixth would push past the frame — split the slide instead.

The featured panel makes the claim; this side supports it.

A dark left panel carries the headline, and the bright right column holds up to three supporting items.

Composition: dark · split-panel dark

Two zones, one argument

The split is hierarchy, not decoration — the panel claims, the column proves.

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Sixteen words per item keeps the column scannable.

The featured panel makes the claim; this side supports it.

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Composition: compact · split-panel compact

Two zones, one argument

The split is hierarchy, not decoration — the panel claims, the column proves.

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Sixteen words per item keeps the column scannable.

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Composition: accent · split-panel accent

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When NOT to reach for split-panel.

A binary decision with a verdict

If the slide weighs two options and lands a recommendation, use `split-compare` — its right zone is a 2-option grid + a verdict card, which `split-panel` does not provide.

Co-equal halves

split-panel is asymmetric — a featured panel beside supporting detail. For two co-equal options side by side, use `compare-prose`.

A list with no feature

If there's no prominent left-panel element, a plain `list` or `cards-stack` serves better — the panel earns its place only when one element leads.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`split-compare` — a binary decision with a recommendation card

`compare-prose` — two co-equal options side by side

`big-number` — the hero number is the whole slide, with no supporting list

`list-steps` — an ordered process without a left anchor panel